



rules for ARKHAM HORROR



THE YEAR IS 1926, and strange things are happening in Arkham, Massachusetts – a town with a sinister past. Strange lights glow in the graveyard. A local citizen has vanished without a trace. Hear the odd fluting in the woods? See the huge tracks surrounding Founder's Rock? The people of Arkham are near panic and only you, brave investigators, can rescue them from unimaginable evil.

Starting The Game



ONE: Separate the card and money sheets, and punch out the 50 counters. Separate the various rules, gazettes, and "About Your Investigator" sheets.

Sort the cards into decks. Place the Gates, Items, and Spells decks on the corresponding gameboard spaces. Hold the Local Characters, Retainers, and any extra Skills and Charity cards to one side of the board. Sort the money by denomination.

Reserving the Doom Factor counter, put the monsters into a coffee mug or otherwise arrange them so that they can be drawn randomly.

If investigators are started later in the game, follow the procedures described in the "About Your Investigator" sheet titled "Starting a New Investigator."

TWO: Each player chooses an investigator. (If there are 2-3 players, each should take 2 investigators; if there is 1 player, take 3 investigators.) Find the investigator token or tokens of matching color. Be sure to read "About Your Investigator."

THREE: Decide how to share tasks. One player can make change; another can consult the rules; another can read off location table results.

FOUR: As beginning equipment for each investigator, deal \$13 from the bank, 3 item cards, 1 skill card, 1 spell card, and 1 charity card. If there are more than 4 investigators, deal only 2 item cards for each.

Investigators may trade cards and money throughout the game, provided that the traders are in the same space or location and that skill cards are not traded once play begins.

FIVE: Divide 10 points between your investigator's starting strength points and sanity points, each to have at least 3 and not more than 7. Take a moment to figure out the sort of person that your investigator is, and what he or she does for a living. Introduce your investigator to the rest of the group by name.

SIX: Place investigator tokens in play at the Train Station, near the north border of Arkham.

ORDER OF PLAY

Investigator Phase

Collect Money if on Retainer;
Return to Arkham if Starting on Other
Worlds Box 1; and

1. Investigator Acts:

- Waits, or
- Moves, or
- Moves and Takes Taxi.

2. Investigator Encounters:

- Waits, or
- Rolls for Encounter,
- Adds Sanity Points,
- Adds Strength Points,
- Earns/Loses Money,
- Purchases/Finds Item,
- Uses a Skill,
- Uses a Charity Card,
- Meets a Monster.

3. Investigator Meets a Monster:

- Has a Sanity Roll, (maybe)
- Goes Temporarily Insane, or
- Waits,
- Sneaks, or
- Fights.

4. Investigator Fights:

- Attacks and
- Risks Counterattack.

Mythos Phase

1. Random Gate Appears:

- Roll On Gate Appearance Table.

2. All Monsters Move.

3. All Monsters Attack:

- Make Applicable Investigator Sanity Rolls,
- Monster Attacks,
- Investigator Sneaks, or
- Investigator Counterattacks.



When the investigators have finished, the Mythos Phase begins. Gates and monsters may appear, and monsters may attack.

When all the monsters have moved and all attacks have been made, the two phases are completed, concluding one game turn. Unless the victory or loss conditions have been met, begin a new game turn.

At times, spells and items may be found or purchased. Payment goes to the bank, unless the deal is with another player. As spells and items are accumulated, lay them in front of you. Retain monsters killed, as well.

The number of game turns has no limit, though players may choose a limit.

Winning And Losing

In game turn 2 and thereafter, if all the gates are eliminated then the players win.

The game can be lost in two ways.

- By the presence of a minimum number of gates on the board for a full game turn: if 1-3 investigators start, when 8 gates are present, you lose; if 3-4 investigators start, when 7 gates are present, you lose; if 5 or more investigators start, 6 gates.

- Or by the appearance of a total number of gates on the board. Use the doom factor counter and the doom track to record the total number of gates appearing during the game, including any which the investigators destroy or donate to the Benevolent Order of Dagon Mission. When the doom factor reaches "Doom of Arkham," the players lose. The spacetime continuum has been altered, and the dimensional walls collapse which staved off the Old Ones.

By agreement, adjust these numbers; let the goal fit your style of play, and never let it interfere with your enjoyment.

Win or lose, the surviving investigator who closes the most gates is proclaimed First Citizen of Arkham, and is entered on the Roll of Honor, along with the name of the player. If tied, the investigator wins who has the most monsters in his or her trophy stack.



INVESTIGATOR PHASE

Investigator Step 1:

Investigator Acts

An investigator can choose to move, or decide to wait.

Investigator Moves

To move, roll 2D6. Unless encountering a monster, the investigator may move as many spaces as indicated by the result, fewer, or

SEVEN: Select the top gate card, and consult the Gate Appearance table on the gameboard to learn on which location to put the card, face down. Randomly select three monsters and put them face up on the gated location. Put the Doom Factor counter on space 1 of the doom track. The threat has begun.

EIGHT: Each player rolls two six-sided dice (abbreviated 2D6): the highest roller moves first. Continue play to the left, once around the table each turn.

How To Play

Follow the order of play. During the Investigator Phase, the players' investigators complete all movement, attacks, etc., in the order around which the players sit at the table.

none at all. Entering or exiting a location counts as a move of 1 space (exception: entering or exiting a gate takes no movement).

Upon entering a location, an investigator stops. Stopping does not preclude the investigator ending the turn in an Other World.

An investigator entering a space or location containing a monster must stop, with three exceptions: (1) an investigator enjoying a vehicle ride moves through most monsters without stopping but, if an alternate route cannot be traced, a < blocker > monster stops vehicular traffic one space distant from it; (2) an investigator equipped with the Mists of R'Lyeh; (3) an investigator can move through the Hound of Tindalos at any time unless the Hound is in a building.

Entering and Exiting Gameboard Locations

When moving into a location an investigator may have an encounter, meet a monster, or destroy a gate. Exception: when being carried through by a nightgaunt to another world, nothing happens in the transited location.

Pointers indicate the street spaces from which investigators may enter gameboard locations. To enter, put the token on the building, lake, etc., close beside the street pointer. An investigator does not need to enter a location on an exact movement count.

Upon entering a gameboard location, the investigator's player must either meet any monster(s) there or roll a D6 and consult the corresponding location table. If the location contains a gate the investigator may instead transit via that gate directly to an Other World and avoid the location event. If a gate appears as a result of a location event, the investigator is swept to the Other World involuntarily.

If entering an Other World, the player immediately rolls on the gate table for the Other World. The transition from location to Other World does not count as movement.

One location event may lead an investigator to another location. Just as with gates, roll again on the table for the second location after moving there (unless there are monsters there, then just meet them).

Entering and Exiting Other Worlds

Investigators go to Other Worlds to gather useful items and spells, and to find the other sides of gates in order to destroy them.

When a gate exists, the location and the Other World are dimensionally coterminous: movement between costs no movement points.

When entering a gated location, the investigator chooses whether to roll on the gate table or the location table: if using the gate table, then move the investigator token to box 2 of the Other World; if selecting the location table, then the investigator token stays in Arkham. Just as the investigator token is in one plane of existence but not both, a monster either is in Arkham or an Other World.

Sometimes a gate and monster appear as a location event. Then the investigator has no choice: he or she is swept into the Other World to undergo an encounter on that gate table — not meeting the monster that appeared in the Arkham location, nor undergoing any sanity loss.

Monsters never pursue investigators through gates.

If a monster and gate already are present, an investigator may attempt to use his Sneak skill to move past the monster and into the Other World, after surviving any sanity roll. If the Sneak fails, the investigator receives one die of damage to Strength. If he survives, he can again try to Sneak through the gate.

Reaching Other World box 2, roll on the gate table. If the investigator survives, move the token to box 1 when it is next your turn. Then roll again on the gate table. If the investigator survives, on the third turn move the investigator back to Arkham, to the gate of departure. While on the Other world, follow the order of play normally, as you would while in Arkham.

An investigator reaching zero sanity or zero strength points in an Other World is lost. Return and reshuffle the cards, and put the trophies in the monster pile. Start another investigator.

OPTION: An investigator lost in an Other World can be rescued if another investigator lands on the same box.

The rescue can be effected in two ways. The lost investigator can be shifted from box to box and back to Arkham with a successful strength roll by the rescuer for each move. Alternately, the rescuer can give the lost investigator sanity or strength points by means of a spell or magical item.

The player of the lost investigator must agree to do nothing during the turns needed to effect the rescue, or the players must agree that one player can have more than one investigator in play.

Returning from an Other World, an investigator begins movement in the matching Arkham gate, choosing which if two gates to the same Other World are on the board. If a monster guards the gate, the investigator can move away without a sanity roll, because he or she is beginning movement in the location.

If the investigator wants to attack the gate, he or she waits for the attack step, taking any

sanity loss for a guardian monster. If the gate is destroyed, any guardians are sucked away and added to the investigator's trophy pile.

Investigator Moves And Takes Taxi

Any investigator reaching a Taxi space or using the Taxi Whistle card and wishing a ride can pay \$1 and immediately go to any space or location in Arkham, concluding movement there. Taking a taxi costs no movement points.

Location events often offer free movement to another location. If accepted, treat the move as if by free taxi.

Investigator Step 2: Investigator Encounters



Investigators stop on empty spaces without other effect.

An investigator may find or earn or lose money, purchase or find an item, use a skill, etc., from results on location event and gate event tables. A free ride is declinable unless the Sheldon Gang gives it. A result may be optional.

If a gate and monster appear because of a location result, draw one of each and put them on the location. The investigator stumbles into it and is swept to that Other World, without meeting the monster, there to take a result from that gate table.

If at a location with a gate, the investigator can choose to enter the gate or can decide to take a random event from the location's table. A monster in a location is an encounter in itself: don't roll. A successful Sneak may take the investigator to a different encounter.

Only one gate exists at a location. Add only the monster if a second gate appearance is rolled for at a location.

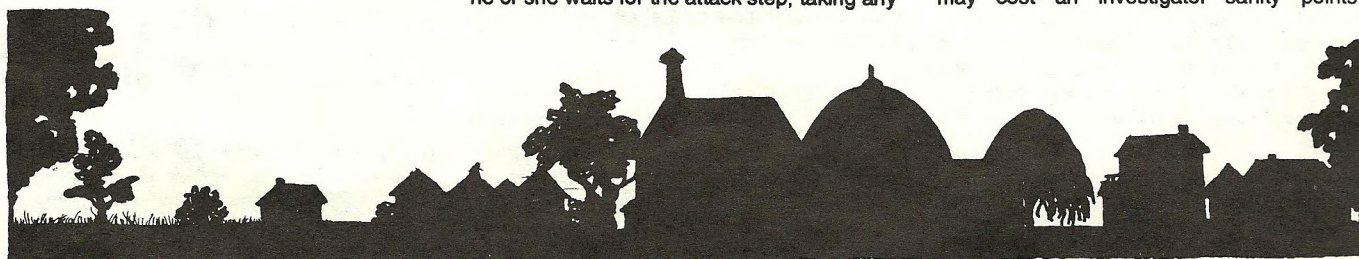
Investigator Step 3: Meeting Monsters



Monsters move about the board. They appear because of a location or a gate event.

Sanity

Monsters are horrible-looking. Meeting one may cost an investigator sanity points.



Monster pieces bear an abbreviation SAN (sanity) followed by two numbers. The number before the slash is the amount of sanity points lost with a successful D6 sanity roll. The number after the slash is the amount of sanity points lost if the roll fails. For some monsters both numbers are zero: though frightening, the encounter is not mind-threatening.

Make only one sanity roll per individual monster per game turn. Adjust the sanity point marker on the investigator card as sanity rises and falls.

To Sneak away from more than one species of monster in a space, roll the Sneak first, then make a sanity roll for the single most ghastly type of monster. Only roll for sanity if your Sneak succeeds: if it fails, you'll get to make the sanity roll before your investigator fights.

If your investigator wishes to attack, make sanity rolls for each monster attacked, just before the individual attack.

If the investigator's sanity reaches zero, put him or her in the Sanitarium immediately. There is no movement cost charge, and the transfer happens out of step or phase, as needed. Discard one spell card of choice, if held, as penalty. Going insane in the midst of combat protects the investigator from monster attention, as readers of Lovecraft know.

Sneaking

To Sneak, roll D6. If the result is equal to or less than the amount of the investigator's Sneak skill, put the investigator in an adjacent space or location of the player's choice. If monsters occupy all adjacent spaces, a Sneak cannot be performed.

Exception: the Hound of Tindalos cannot be escaped by Sneaking.

An investigator can Sneak past a gate guardian and thereby enter an Other World.

Sneak can be used against monsters on an Other World: with a success, remove the monster and leave the investigator in the box.

Investigator Step 4:

Investigator Fights



The investigator can attack using the amount of his or her Fight skill, one or two items held in his or her hands, other magical items, and spells.

If making attacks with items marked as one-handed or two-handed, the attacks must be possible. An investigator can employ two 1H weapons or one 2H weapon in one fight.

An investigator can always add Fight to any combination of physical weapons. Fight does not affect monsters immune to physical attack.

Total the numerical strength of spells actually cast, items actually used, the investigator's Fight skill, and the result of a D6 roll. The monster may be immune to all or some investigator physical attacks, though the D6 roll always is effective.

Compare the total to the monster's strength points. If the investigator's total is equal to or greater than the monster's, then the investigator triumphs and the monster counter immediately is added to the investigator's trophy stack.

If the monster survives, then the investigator suffers an automatic loss of D6 strength points from the angry monster's counterattack. If the investigator's hit points reach zero in Arkham, immediately place the incapacitated investigator in the hospital and lose one item of choice; if his or her strength points reach zero in an Other World, start a new investigator.

An investigator may attack as many times as there are targets in his or her space. A monster may defend (counterattack) any number of times.

If several monsters, choose the order of attack. Make a sanity roll for each, just before each attack. Ignore a sanity roll for the second, etc., monster of the same species.

• Should both monster and investigator survive a round of combat, they fight again if the investigator wishes, or the investigator might attempt a Sneak.

Destroying Gates

Destroy gates by using any combination of magical and physical attacks, plus a D6 roll. Attack during step 4. If not destroyed then, the investigator must wait to attack it next turn, and the next, etc.

If an investigator returns through a gate to attack and then leaves the gated location before destroying the gate, he or she must repeat the discovery of both sides of the gate, holders of the Dragon's Eye or the Blue Watcher excepted.

If a monster or monsters are guarding a gate that is destroyed, the implosion sucks the creature(s) to another plane: add the guardians to your investigator's trophy stack.

Add to his or her trophy stack each gate your investigator destroys.

Each Other World is color-keyed to certain monsters. If in play, put monsters corresponding to a just-closed gate back into the monster pile, but not into the investigator's trophy stack.

• Physical force, magical spells, or a combination of the two, specifically including the Bind Monster spell, can destroy a gate. The investigator must first find the gate and then pass through it. Once on the other side,

he or she must find the way back. When the investigator returns to the Arkham end of the gate, he or she can destroy the gate with an attack equal to or greater than the listed strength points for the gate.

• The Dragon's Eye and the Blue Watcher of the Pyramid cards can destroy gates. Take one to a gate. It is unnecessary find both sides of the gate. After any encounter at the location, the gate is closed and the card is put back in the items deck. Subtract any personal damage.

• After finding both sides of the gate, placing an Elder Sign upon a gate and spending 2 sanity points destroys the gate. It may not be moved, once used. It blocks future gate and monster appearances in that location, though Hounds of Tindalos may enter and attack in specified locations.

MYTHOS PHASE



During this phase the players work together to operate the monsters and powers of the Cthulhu Mythos. Talk about the problems, and try to arrive at just conclusions. It is not important that any one player perform any special task, but complete all tasks in the order given.

For terms relating to monsters, see the terms section in "About Your Investigator."

Mythos Step 1:

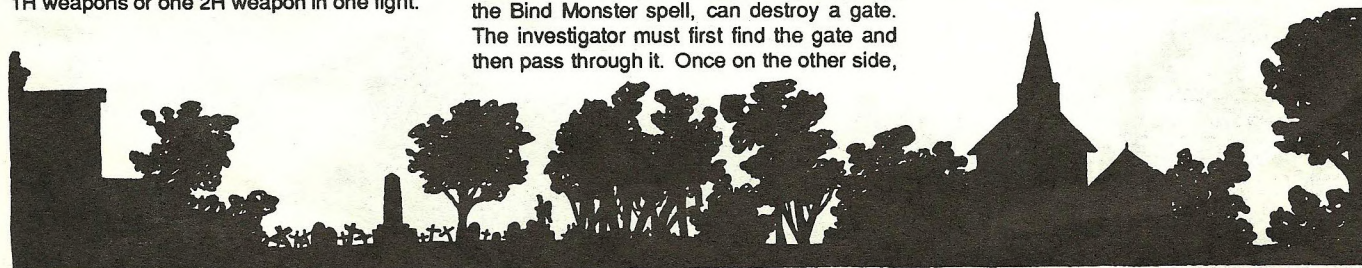
Gates Appear

Gates are doorways to the Other Worlds boxes at the top of the gameboard. They represent other times, dimensions, or planets. Cthulhu monsters travel to Earth by means of gates. Investigators destroy gates to end the horrors threatening Arkham and thereby win the game.

A gate appears on the game board (1) as a location event and (2) during the Random Gate Appears step of the Mythos phase. A gate may or may not appear in a turn.

In the Mythos phase, roll on the Gate Appearance table. If a gate appears, draw a gate card and a random monster and put them on the gameboard: the Gate Appearance table determines the location if not established. If the location already contains a gate, place only the monster there. Exception: a location guarded by an Elder Sign produces no gate or monster.

An investigator suffering a "Gate and Monster Appear" result is sucked through the



gate to the corresponding Other World. The monster remains on the location, to move and attack in Arkham.

When an investigator goes through a gate, turn the gate card face up so that the destination can be known. Otherwise leave the gate card face down.

Monsters Appear

Monsters appear as the result of the Gate Appearance step in the Mythos Phase or as the result of a location event or a gate event during the Investigator Phase.

When a monster appears, draw a random monster counter from the pile and place it where the investigator is.

Often a monster appears in an Other World. Draw the monster from the pile. If the investigator wins, add it to his or her trophy stack. If it wins it inflicts D6 damage to the investigator's Strength. If the investigator perishes, the monster goes back into the monster pile.

The Monster Pieces

On the front side of the monster counter is its silhouette, an arrow if the monster moves, and a circle or diamond if the thing is handed. On the other side is its name, its bracketed class if it has one, a circle or diamond if it is handed, the monster's strength points, the sanity cost to investigators who meet the thing, and occasionally a special notation. Head the arrow in its direction of movement.

Both sides of some monster pieces are color-matched to the color tint of an Other World. When the gate to an Other World is destroyed, remove any matching monsters and put them in the monster pile. Monsters so removed may return normally to play, and are not added to a trophy stack.

After moving with the silhouette up, turn over the monster piece if it is attacking or being attacked. Resolve the fight, then turn the piece back to its silhouette side. Surviving an encounter with an investigator, a monster piece may be positioned within a space as the player chooses.



Mythos Step 2:

Monsters Move

Monsters move during the monster movement phase of the game turn. The number of spaces moved by each monster is given on each piece.

Monsters attack by moving into spaces containing investigators. Monsters appear in locations and move out of locations, but cannot move into locations. See the "Tindalos" entry in the game terms section for exceptions.

Monsters, though unintelligent, patrol ceaselessly. A monster stops moving after maximum movement or when meeting an investigator in a space.

Direction of Movement

When a monster appears, place it on the appropriate location. Use the arrow to determine the direction the monster moves. At intersections, move it left (L) or right (R) as its handedness indicates.

Flyers (flying monsters) have no handedness. As reminders, they are marked < flyer > and carry an F before the number of spaces moved: F-4, for instance. Flyers move on streets, always toward the nearest investigator. If two or more investigators are equally close, a flyer attacks the one with the highest Fight skill. If equal Fights, flip a coin.



Mythos Step 3:

Monsters Attack

A monster attacks by moving into the space or location where one or more investigators rest. Determine any sanity loss.

The nearest monster moving into the space attacks the investigator with the higher Fight skill. If one or both of the factors are equal, flip a coin: the higher monster attacks the higher investigator, etc. Once the opponent is determined, make any needed sanity rolls for the investigator(s).

The investigator totals a D6 roll, his Fight, and applicable spells and items. Compare that sum to the monster's strength points. If the investigator has a total equal to or higher than the monster's strength points, the investigator wins the combat and adds the monster to his or her trophy stack.

If the investigator's total is lower than the monster's strength points, the investigator loses D6 strength points.

A monster must continue to attack until the target no longer occupies the space, location, or Other World.

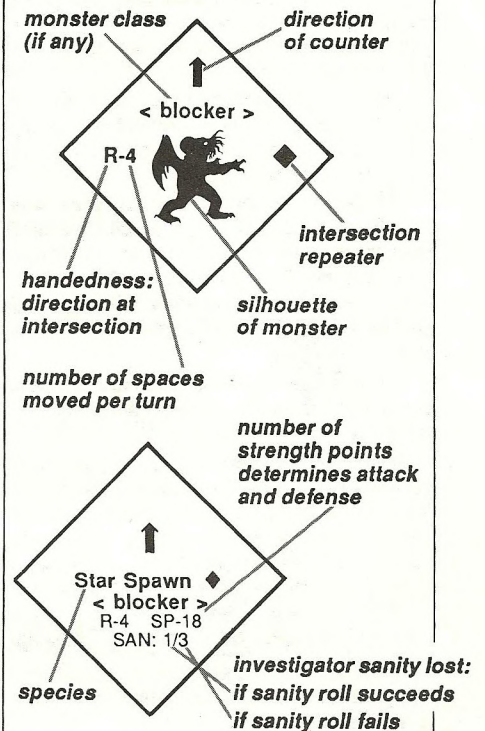
Alone of the monsters, the Tindalos counter is put back into the monster pile after any attack which costs an investigator strength points.

With a Bind Monster spell, a monster may be directed to attack another monster.

This concludes the sequential rules. For information concerning investigators, strength points, sanity points, skills, spell casting, particular spells, items, charity cards, making trades, starting a new investigator, the Roll of Honor, game questions and answers, further examples of play, and game terms, procedures, and card explanations, see the folder titled "About Your Investigator."

About The Monster Pieces

FRONT OF COUNTER



BACK OF COUNTER

NB: monsters are colored differently to match the colors of Other Worlds on the gameboard. When a gate is destroyed, any monsters on the board matching the color of the Other World that the gate represents are removed and put back in the monster pile.

